



Welcome

Personal Development Portfolio Skills Planning Student Support

2026-2027

www.strath.ac.uk

Welcome to your development journey

Your degree is more than the knowledge you gain. It is also the skills, confidence and professional identity you build along the way.

Personal and Professional Development Planning (PDP) helps you reflect on your progress, recognise your strengths and make purposeful choices about what comes next.

Your Personal Development Portfolio turns that planning into action. As you progress through your studies, the tasks you complete will help you capture achievements, identify priorities and build evidence for future opportunities.

Engage with it regularly — it is your space to shape the scientist and professional you want to become.

A WELCOME FROM



**Director of
BMS Programmes**
**Prof. Margaret
Cunningham**



**BMS
Administrator
- D&W Liaison**
Mrs Jacqui Miller

STUDENT HANDBOOK • YOUR FIRST POINT OF REFERENCE

Start with your Student Handbook

It brings the essential information for your year of study together in one place — so it should be your first stop when you have a question.

- 01 READ IT FIRST** Understand the key information and expectations for your programme.

- 02 RETURN TO IT** Check guidance, contacts and support routes whenever you need them.

- 03 ASK IF UNSURE** Use the handbook to find the right person or service for further help.

Not sure where to begin? Begin with the handbook.

YOUR YEAR • YOUR HANDBOOK

UNIVERSITY OF STRATHCLYDE • FACULTY OF SCIENCE

Strathclyde Institute of Pharmacy & Biomedical Sciences

Biomolecular Science Student Handbook

SESSION 2026/2027

Accredited
Degree

Accredited by the Royal Society of Biology • BSc (Hons) Biomedical Science accredited by the IBMS

FIND IT ON MYPLACE

Open your main BM Year page

Keep it somewhere easy to
return to throughout the year.

STUDENT SUPPORT • KNOW WHERE TO START

Where can I get support?

You do not need to work it out alone — choose the route that matches what you need.

01 COURSE QUESTIONS

Year or Module Coordinator

Support with course-related issues.

02 ACADEMIC GUIDANCE

Advisor of Studies

Help with academic matters and Pegasus.

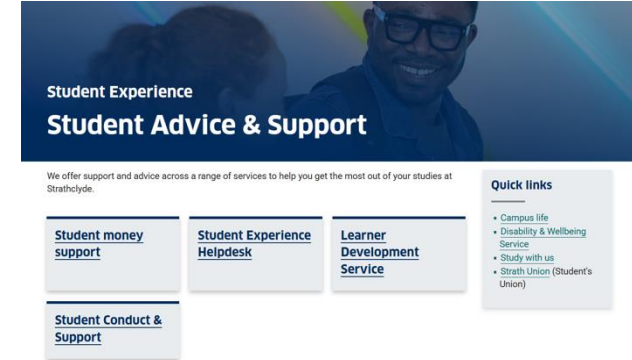
03 YOUR DEVELOPMENT

Personal Development Advisor (PDA)

Academic Family, degree progress, PDP, skills and CV development.

If you are unsure where to begin, asking for guidance is the right first step.

STUDENT SUPPORT & DEVELOPMENT



Scan for student support information



Student Support & Development

Welcome to your Advisors of Studies

Your Advisor of Studies is here to help you navigate the academic side of your degree — from curriculum choices and changes to progression and course-related questions. Your Advisor and Deputy work together, so contact them early when you need guidance or help understanding your options.



YEAR 1

Dr Kiani Jeacock

DEPUTY ADVISOR

Dr Robert Drummond



YEAR 2

Ms Molly Huq

DEPUTY ADVISOR

Dr Andrew Paul



YEAR 3

Dr Morgan Feeney

DEPUTY ADVISOR

Dr Dino Rotondo



YEAR 4

Dr Kathryn McIntosh

PROJECTS COORINDATOR

Dr Calum Wilson



MSci

Prof. Shuzo Sakata

DEPUTY ADVISOR

Dr Matthew Lee

You do not need to have everything worked out before getting in touch — start the conversation, and your year team will help you find the right next step.

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT ADVISOR • YOUR ACADEMIC MENTOR

Your PDA turns progress into purpose

A consistent point of contact throughout your degree — someone who gets to know your journey, not just your results.

- | | | |
|-----------|----------------|--|
| 01 | REFLECT | Make sense of your academic progress, strengths and priorities. |
| 02 | DEVELOP | Build confidence, professional awareness and evidence of growth. |
| 03 | CONNECT | Talk through concerns early and find the right specialist support. |

Do not wait for a small concern to become a big problem — contact your PDA early.

PDA

Personal Development
Advisor

WHAT TO EXPECT

Regular conversations

A confidential space to talk

Guidance and signposting

Curriculum changes are normally handled by your Adviser of Studies.

Welcome to Career Services

Your career journey starts now — and the Careers & Employability Service is here to support you throughout your studies.

Use the service at any stage to explore career options, understand where your degree can take you and find ways to build relevant skills and experience.

You can also access practical guidance for job searching, CVs and applications, interviews, assessment centres and further study — helping you move forward with confidence.

Start early, stay curious and make use of the support available to you.

YOUR FACULTY CONTACT



Stephen Smith
Careers and
Employability
Consultant
Science Faculty

MEET THE CAREERS TEAM

strath.ac.uk/careers/meettheteam

Life sciences is hiring. Is your skills plan ready?

What the UK Government's 2026 Life Sciences Skills Needs Assessment means for you as a biomolecular scientist

~118,000

workers needed in priority life sciences jobs, 2025–2035 (growth + replacing leavers)

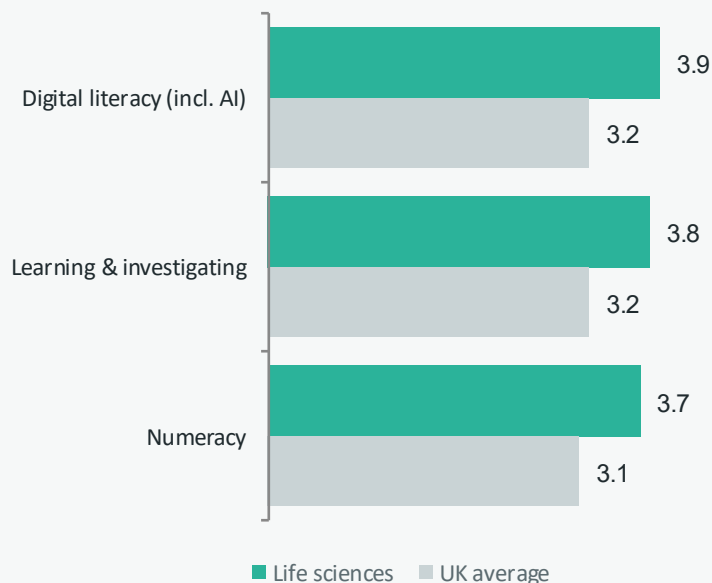
83%

of the new jobs need degree-level (level 4+) qualifications

73%

of priority occupations are already in high or critical demand

Core skills needed: sector vs UK average



Proficiency required, scale 1 (minimal) to 5 (expert)

The job is changing

- Hybrid “science + data/AI” roles are growing, e.g. bench scientist who is also a bioinformatician
- AI extends your scientific judgement; humans still interpret and sign off
- Employers want responsible AI skills: data ethics, governance and regulatory compliance

Your move: plan your PDP like an experiment

1 Audit

Rate yourself on the skills above



2 Target

Pick 2–3 gaps tied to target roles



3 Evidence

Log proof in your Skills Passport

Portfolio Development - Employability Module



<https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/careers/students/modules/undergraduatecareersmodule/>

Careers & Employability Service

Undergraduate Careers Module

This module has been created by the Careers and Employability Service. It draws on content from You're Hired! Graduate Career Handbook by Tristram Hooley and Korin Grant. It also incorporates material developed by our Careers Consultants.

Watch this [short video introducing the module](#)

Enrol

Who is this module for?

It's been developed for all current undergraduate students from 1st year. You'll find it helpful whatever stage you are at.

It focuses on career and employability learning. It provides you with insights into the process of transition, from university to work or further study. This includes an understanding of the processes of career choice and career development. It also explores graduate recruitment processes and the labour market. Find out more about the content using the drop-down sections below.

- are you a postgraduate student? We have created a [postgraduate careers module](#) tailored to the needs of students studying at postgraduate level. Please enrol on that module instead
- are you a graduate? Unfortunately you cannot access MyPlace which hosts this module. However, our [Careers Toolkit](#) has some fantastic resources that cover many of these topics
- are you an autistic student or graduate interested in developing your employability skills? Then this free, online course [Employability Skills for Autistic Students & Graduates](#) has been created by a team of experts, including autistic graduates, autistic workplace mentors, non-autistic university careers consultants, and non-autistic researchers
- find out more about [how the University supports student employability](#)

Contact Careers

yourcareer@strath.ac.uk

[Our location](#)

Level 4, Jocelyn Bell-Burnell Wing

Office hours: Monday to Friday Online and by phone
9am to 5pm

In person 10am to 4pm

Tel: 0141 574 5090



What does the module involve?

This module is not credit-bearing. That means you can go at your own pace. You may decide to work through it from start to finish or dip into sections and topics that are most relevant to the stage you're at.

We have organised the module content for each topic in a 'book'. Click on the icon to begin working through that topic. Each book contains information, activities, and further resources. These are accompanied by suggestions for follow-up activities.

We have drawn on content from You're Hired! Graduate Career Handbook. We have provided online access to it through the University library. For EXPLORE and PLAN you are encouraged to read a chapter of the book before working through each topic.

Further information

Show all

What will the Careers and Employability module cover? ▾

Learning outcomes ▾

EXPLORE - find out more about this section of the module ▾

PLAN - find out more about this section of the module ▾

APPLY - find out more about this section of the module ▾

I have further questions, who do I contact? ▾

Note – this module will be phased out but students will have access for Semester 1
Use it before we lose it!!

Portfolio Development (Myplace)

You can access your PDP on Myplace through the 'Being a Biomolecular Scientist' modules. There is a dedicated section.

- PDP is linked to BM110, BM214, BM327 and BM432 'Being a Biomolecular Scientist' modules.
- Please take time to go through the PDP Section on Myplace to find out exactly what you need to do.
- Complete each task before you meet with your PDA for your 1-2-1 meetings.
- PDP Tasks are Compulsory components of the 'Being a Biomolecular Scientist' modules. Failure to complete the tasks will lead to non-qualification and will impact progression to the next year of study.

Note – PDP Sections will be open next week. Tasks and deadlines will be clear and are designed to shape your first conversation with your Personal Development Advisor (PDA).

PORTFOLIO DEVELOPMENT • TASK 1 • CV BUILDER

A CV with gaps is doing its job

This is not a test of how much experience you already have. It is a clear view of where you are now — and what you could build next.

THE TOOL HELPS YOU

- 01 REVIEW** your current CV honestly
- 02 RECOGNISE** strengths and missing experience
- 03 PLAN** the next opportunities to pursue

Your CV becomes the starting point for a focused career conversation with your PDA.

TAKE A QUICK LOOK



Scan to preview the CV Builder before completing your submission.

YOUR ACTION

Upload your CV
by the October deadline

YOUR DEVELOPMENT • CORE ACTIVITIES • PDA TOUCHPOINTS

Four commitments matter

Complete the core activities, attend each PDA touchpoint and use every conversation to ask for support.

WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

01	JOIN	Attend the Welcome Week (September) and Consolidation Week (January) Academic Family meetings.
02	COMPLETE	Enrol on the Employability Module and complete the module activities.
03	UPLOAD	Use the CV tool in the Being a Biomolecular Scientist Myplace PDP section. Draft your current CV, save it as a PDF and upload it before your October 1-to-1.
04	MEET	Respond to Myplace communications, schedule your PDA meetings and attend each conversation.

Your PDA may later provide your graduate reference — use every meeting to get advice and support throughout your studies.

YOUR PDA CALENDAR

4 meetings

Two touchpoints in each semester

SEMESTER 1

17 SEP 2026	Meeting 1 Induction session
19 OCT 2026	Meeting 2 Week commencing

SEMESTER 2

14 JAN 2027	Meeting 3 Consolidation session
8 FEB 2027	Meeting 4 Week commencing

PEER NETWORK • STAFF-STUDENT PARTNERSHIP • SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

Want to build your skills? Engage with PEER.

Tell us what would help you develop — and the PEER Network can work with students and staff to make it happen.

WHAT PEER CAN HELP CREATE

- | | | |
|-----------|---------------------------------|---|
| 01 | SKILLS SURGERIES | Focused support shaped around learning needs. |
| <hr/> | | |
| 02 | STUDENT-LED ACTIVITY | Events and opportunities designed with students. |
| <hr/> | | |
| 03 | CONFIDENCE & CAREERS | Development that strengthens study, employability and resilience. |

Bring us the need. Together, we can build the support.

SEE WHAT THE NETWORK CAN DO



FULL PEER REMIT

**Scan to view
the PDF**



CAREER DEVELOPMENT • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY • NETWORKS

Join a Professional Society

Connect with the wider scientific community — and build knowledge, contacts and confidence for your next step.

WHAT MEMBERSHIP CAN OPEN UP

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------|---|
| 01 | LEARN | Access journals, talks, training and member resources. |
| <hr/> | | |
| 02 | CONNECT | Meet students, researchers and academics beyond Strathclyde. |
| <hr/> | | |
| 03 | PROGRESS | Explore careers support, prizes, grants, bursaries and reduced conference fees. |

Many societies offer free or reduced student membership — explore the options and ask the named staff contact if you are unsure where to start.

FIND THE SOCIETY FOR YOUR FIELD

BIOCHEMISTRY

Biochemical Society

PHARMACOLOGY

British Pharmacological Society

MICROBIOLOGY

Microbiology Society

IMMUNOLOGY

British Society for Immunology

BROAD BIOSCIENCE

Royal Society of Biology

BIOMEDICAL SCIENCE

Institute of Biomedical Science

Plus societies for toxicology, physiology, neuroscience and cell biology.

EXPLORE THE OPTIONS

Open your main BM Year page on Myplace

STUDENT COMMUNITY • STUDENT-LED • BIOMEDICAL SCIENCES

Join the Strathclyde Biomedical Sciences Society

Meet students across the programme, take part in society activity and help shape a welcoming community.

WHAT YOU CAN GET INVOLVED IN

- | | | |
|----|----------------|---|
| 01 | MEET | Join welcome events, socials and activities organised by the student committee. |
| 02 | STUDY | Use the weekly study-group space to work alongside students from every year. |
| 03 | CONNECT | Build friendships, share experience and stay involved through the society's channels. |

It is your student society — sign up, come along and make it part of your Strathclyde experience.

READY TO JOIN?



**Scan to open the Strath
Union society page**

STANDARD MEMBERSHIP

£3.30

Or visit the Strath Union website
and search “Biomedical Sciences
Society”.

@strathbiomed

GET INVOLVED • STUDENT VOICE • SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Make the next Culture Shock

Join the student editorial board behind SIPBS's science magazine — and turn your interests into experience beyond assessment.

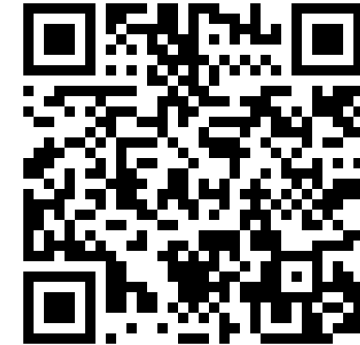
HOW YOU CAN SHAPE THE MAGAZINE

- 01 **PITCH** Bring the scientific questions, stories and perspectives you want the magazine to explore.
- 02 **CREATE** Work with other students to research, write, edit and shape engaging content.
- 03 **GROW** Build communication, collaboration and publishing experience for your portfolio.

You do not need to be an expert — bring your curiosity, your ideas and your voice.

CULTURE SHOCK

A student-led science magazine @ SIPBS



Scan to read Culture Shock

YOUR NEXT STEP

Join the editorial board

STUDENT SUPPORT

Non-Academic Support

Other University Support

Finance

Student financial assistance

For additional information on Financial Assistance, see our [Student Money Support Team](#) and Award Agencies section on the [Tuition Fees](#) pages.

Enquiries for the following points are dealt by our Student Money Support Team team:

- Discretionary Fund
- Childcare Fund
- University's Emergency Aid Fund

[Accommodation fees](#)

[Methods of payment](#)

[Debt management policy](#) 

[Stipend, payment schedule and information](#)

[Tuition fees](#)

[US direct federal loan](#)

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/finance/student/financialassistance/>

Digital Inclusion Programme

Apply

[Eligibility](#) [Further Information](#) [Apply](#) [Contact us](#)

Key facts

 **Number of scholarships:** Variable

 **Value:** Equipment grant

 **Opens:** 18 August 2025

 **Deadline:** 26 June 2026

 **Helps with:** Equipment and study costs

 **Duration:** Provides laptop grant for the duration of studies

Summary

The University of Strathclyde Digital Inclusion Programme is a technology loan scheme for students who reside in the UK and do not have access to an appropriate PC or Laptop to support their learning.

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/scholarships/digitalinclusionequipmentloanscheme/>

Discretionary Fund

Apply

[Eligibility](#) [Further Information](#) [Apply](#) [Contact us](#)

Key facts

 **Number of scholarships:** Various

 **Value:** Various

 **Opens:** 15 September 2025

 **Deadline:** 10 July 2026

 **Helps with:** Living costs, Travel costs

 **Duration:** One off award

Summary

Are you struggling to cover your essential living costs? Discretionary Fund awards are non-repayable top-ups to your standard student support, such as a student loan. If you are a home (Scotland) student or from the rest of UK (England, Wales or Northern Ireland), you might be eligible for support from the fund.

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/scholarships/discretionaryfund/>

Personal Circumstances

Process for Personal Circumstances

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/studentexperience/studentlifecycle/personalcircumstancesprocedure/>



Essential to log Personal Circumstances if you are absent from University or if you are experiencing challenges

Student Lifecycle

Personal Circumstances & Academic Mitigation

The University acknowledges that students can occasionally encounter circumstances that negatively impact their studies, attendance and/or performance in assessments/exams. The University defines these as personal circumstances.

The [Procedure for the Consideration of Academic Mitigation](#) ensures fair treatment for all students, whether full-time or part-time, protecting them from disadvantages due to circumstances beyond their control.

Notifying the University

If your attendance and/or performance in assessments/exams has been affected by acute, severe, or uncontrollable circumstances, you should record this using the personal circumstances facility in Pegasus.

Students should also inform their academic department of these circumstances as soon as possible.

Recording personal circumstance

1. Log into [Pegasus](#)
2. Use the Filter services box to search for 'Personal Circumstances'
3. Click Personal Circumstances link
4. Click Add circumstance
5. Enter all mandatory fields
6. Click 'Confirm' button

Uploading official supporting evidence (if available)

1. Click the 'Upload Evidence' button on the relevant circumstance
2. Complete mandatory fields
3. Click 'Close' button

Evidence should not be submitted via email, the upload facility in Pegasus is configured to automatically delete supporting documentation in accordance with the university's retention policy.

If returning to your studies following a period of Voluntary Leave of Absence, you can also use this facility to upload your fit-to-resume document (if required). Select 'Fit to Resume' for Circumstance type.

A to Z guide

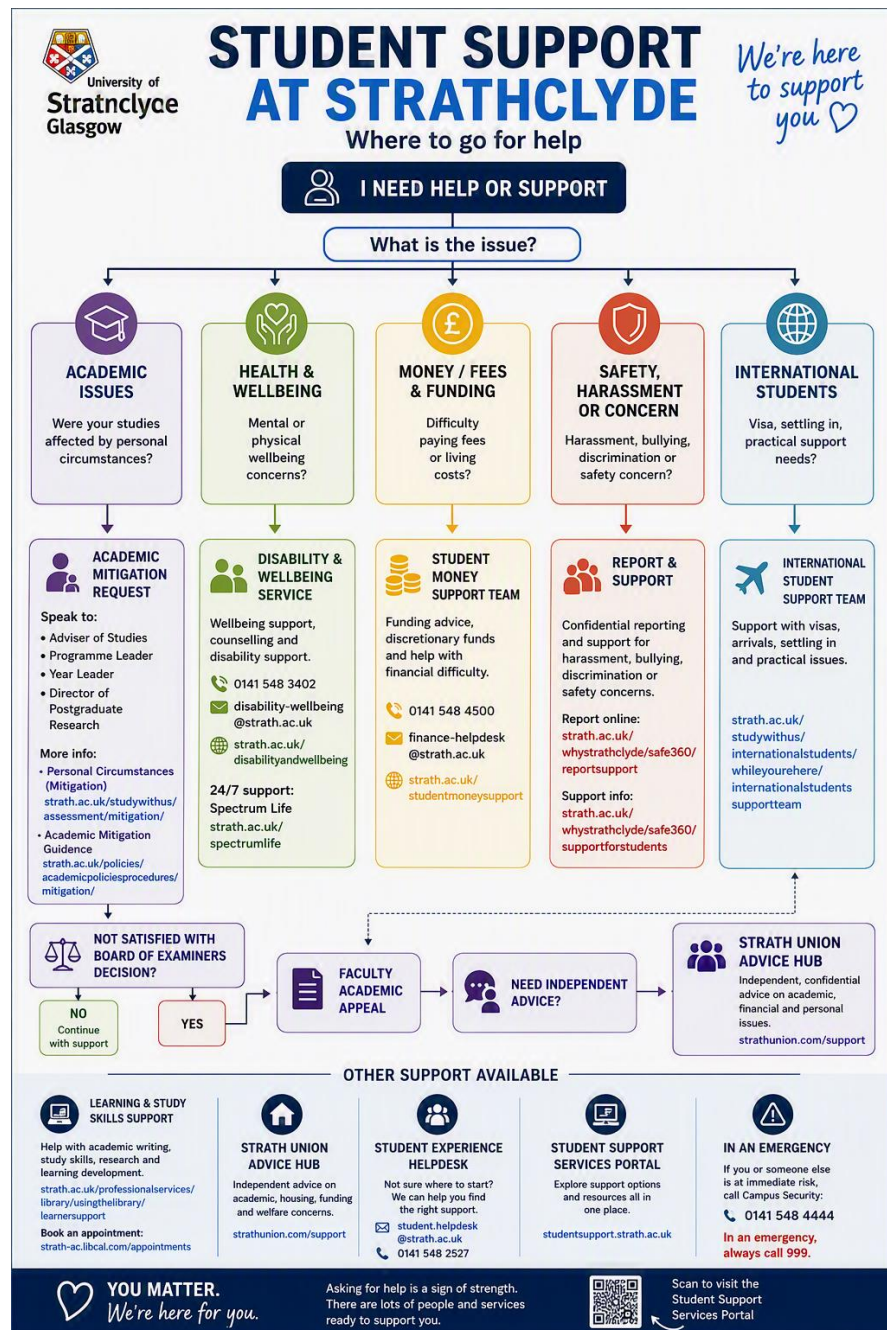


Useful links & documents

- [Academic Policies & Procedures](#)
- [Procedure for the Consideration of Academic Mitigation](#)
- [Academic Support](#)
- [Advice Hub \(at USSA\)](#)
- [Chaplaincy Support](#)
- [Disability & Wellbeing Service](#)
- [Safety & Security](#)
- [Voluntary Leave of Absence](#)

Acceptable evidence

If you're unsure what kinds of evidence would be considered acceptable for personal circumstances, you can consult our [Personal Circumstances Evidence Guide for Students](#)



Tell Strathclyde

Something's not going to plan? Tell us

Most students hit a point where things get harder than expected - money, health, family, loneliness, deadlines, or just the weight of it all. It's normal. What matters is that you don't carry it alone, and that we know early enough to help you.

You don't need a crisis to get in touch, and you don't need to figure things out on your own.

7 in 10

UK students report experiencing loneliness

NPU Mental Health Research

1 in 6

UK undergraduates report experiencing a mental health difficulty during their studies

The Policy Institute at King's College London

24/7

Support available by phone via Spectrum Life wherever you are in the world

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/strathlife/tellstrathclyde/>

Tell Strathclyde

How do I find the right support and action?

START HERE
Tell Strathclyde

Tell Strathclyde is designed around our students and focused on common challenging personal circumstances we know you might experience. It organises and presents support options focused on your circumstances rather than arranged by service areas.

Begin by using Tell Strathclyde to explore potential support and then contact relevant support services. What follows depends on the nature and impact of your circumstances.

Talk it through

Your department or a support service can help to further clarify impact and discuss targeted support for a range of circumstances.

Access support during study

This may include guidance, an extension, or reasonable adjustments, depending on your circumstances.

Evidence may be needed

The requirement depends on the support or process being used.

Formal academic mitigation

Ultimately, if circumstances have affected an assessment, information and evidence may be considered through the relevant formal process.

There is no single support route for every student.

Slides on Myplace

Any Questions?



University of **Strathclyde** Glasgow